

Hande Sodaci, PhD

Behavioral Researcher | Human–AI Interaction | Experimental Design

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SUMMARY

Behavioral researcher with a PhD in Cognitive Psychology and 10+ years of experience designing controlled interaction studies and analyzing trial-level data, focused on how people adapt communication to conversational agents and robots. Works in mixed-effects and ordinal modeling and reproducible analysis in R, and reports findings, including rigorously established null results, in terms that support design decisions.

CORE CAPABILITIES

Research design: Experimental design; user and interaction studies; task and survey design; behavioral coding; human–AI interaction

Data & statistics: Trial-level analysis; mixed-effects and ordinal (cumulative link) models; regression; equivalence testing; reproducible workflows in R; data management

Tools: R; Qualtrics; OpenSesame; ELAN; Choregraphe (NAO robot software); SPSS; JASP; HTML/CSS

Languages: Turkish (native); English (fluent)

EXPERIENCE

Doctoral Researcher @ Koç University, Istanbul

Sep 2020 – Aug 2026

- Led end-to-end behavioral research on how speakers adapt communication to human versus robotic listeners, from study design through analysis, publication, and presentation at IEEE HRI, CogSci, and APS.
- Designed and ran controlled interactive experiments with 160 participants and 6,080 trials, covering protocols, robot interaction programming, participant-data management, and reproducible R pipelines.
- Modeled trial-level data with mixed-effects and cumulative link models to detect real-time adaptation in speakers' level of detail.
- Tested user responses to system feedback and interaction failures, establishing several effects as null through equivalence testing.

Editorial Assistant @ European Open Science, Remote

Jul 2023 – May 2025

- Managed the editorial workflow for 15 academic journals, covering submission checks, revision tracking, copyediting, production, and publication, as primary contact for authors.
- Maintained consistent documentation and process standards across concurrent journal pipelines.

Project Coordinator @ MEF University, Istanbul

Jul 2020 – Jan 2022

- Coordinated operations for a grant-funded longitudinal study (TÜBİTAK 1003), managing research staff, data-collection workflows, and partner-institution communication, and standardizing documentation across collaborating institutions.

Research Assistant @ Tilburg University, Netherlands

Feb 2017 – Feb 2018

- Designed and ran a personalized language-learning study for Turkish–Dutch bilingual children using a NAO social robot with tablet-based interaction, as part of the EU Horizon 2020 L2TOR project.
- Worked with Tilburg and Utrecht teams to localize the system and integrate child-development and interaction requirements into the learning task.

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy, Psychology (Cognitive Track), Koç University, Istanbul

Sep 2020 – Aug 2026

Associate Degree, Web Design and Coding, Anadolu University

Sep 2019 – Jun 2021

Research Master, Language and Communication, Radboud University, Nijmegen

Sep 2016 – Aug 2018

Bachelor of Arts, Psychology, with Certificate in Linguistics, Boğaziçi University, Istanbul

Sep 2011 – Jun 2016

AWARDS & TRAINING

IEEE Robotics & Automation Society Travel Support Award

2026

Data Analysis School, YÖK & Marmara University

2026

TÜBİTAK 2211-A National PhD Scholarship

2020 – 2024

Holland Scholarship, Dutch Ministry of Education, Culture and Science

2016 – 2018

Higher Education Scholarship, Turkish Ministry of Youth and Sports — top 100 nationally, university entrance exam

2011 – 2016

REFERENCES

Prof. Aylin C. Küntay, Department of Psychology, Koç University, Istanbul — doctoral advisor — 0546 224 1251

Prof. Tilbe Göksun, Department of Psychology, Koç University, Istanbul — dissertation monitoring committee member — 0532 725 0438